



Menopause Weight Loss Plan

A practical guide for gradual fat loss, muscle preservation, and healthy aging



Why Weight Gain Happens During Menopause

During menopause, hormonal changes can affect body composition, metabolism, and energy levels.

- Estrogen declines, so more fat may be stored around the abdomen.
- Muscle mass decreases, which can slow metabolism and reduce calorie burning.
- Insulin resistance may increase, making weight management more difficult.
- Poor sleep and higher stress levels can increase hunger and cravings.
- Lower testosterone may contribute to loss of muscle and strength.
- Fatigue and low energy can reduce physical activity.

Designed By:
Dr. Shawana Mufti



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The Goal

“Menopause weight gain is not simply caused by eating too much. Hormonal changes can lead to increased body fat, loss of muscle mass, and a slower metabolism. The goal is to preserve muscle, reduce excess body fat, and support healthy aging.”

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Let's Understand Healthy Weight

Maintaining a healthy weight during menopause is important for overall health. However, body composition matters more than the number on the scale

Body Mass Index (BMI)

$$\text{BMI} = \text{Weight (kg)} / \text{Height}^2 (\text{m}^2)$$

BMI	Category
<18.5	Underweight
18.5-24.9	Healthy Weight
25-29.9	Overweight
≥ 30	Obesity

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Healthy Weight Range by Height

Height	Healthy Weight Range
5'0" (152 cm)	43-58 kg
5'2" (157 cm)	46-62 kg
5'4" (163 cm)	49-66 kg
5'6" (168 cm)	52-71 kg
5'8" (173 cm)	56-75 kg

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Daily Health Goals

Daily Nutrition Targets

- Protein: 80-100 g daily
- Fiber: 25-30 g daily
- Water: 2-3 liters daily
- Vegetables: at least 5 servings daily
- Fruit: 1-2 servings daily
- Include healthy fats daily: olive oil, nuts, seeds, avocado, and omega-3s

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Daily Health Goals

Activity Goals

- Walk 30-45 minutes daily or most days of the week.
- Resistance or strength training 2-3 times weekly.
- Reduce prolonged sitting whenever possible.

Anti-Inflammatory Lifestyle

- Focus on whole, minimally processed foods to support gut health, liver health, metabolic health, and healthy aging.
- Limit sugary drinks, excess sweets, and ultra-processed foods.

Sleep Goal

- Aim for 7-9 hours of quality sleep each night.

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Disclaimer

Individuals with diabetes, kidney disease, liver disease, gastrointestinal disorders, food allergies, or other medical conditions should consult their healthcare provider before making significant dietary changes. Calorie needs vary based on age, height, body weight, physical activity, medications, and medical conditions.

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How to Use This Meal Plan

- Eat meals in the order presented throughout the day.
- Include a source of protein with every meal and snack.
- Choose whole, minimally processed foods whenever possible.
- Drink 2-3 liters of water daily.
- Portion sizes matter.
- Focus on progress, not perfection.
- Consistency is more important than short-term dieting.

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Flexible Food Choices

Foods within the same category may be substituted.

- Chicken, fish, eggs, or lean meat may be exchanged.
- Roti, rice, oats, or other whole grains may be substituted in similar portions.
- Fruits and vegetables may be selected based on availability and preference.

Remember

This meal plan is intended as a practical guide and may be adjusted based on individual needs, preferences, and medical advice





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When You Wake Up

If your healthcare provider has prescribed medications or supplements that should be taken on an empty stomach, such as thyroid medication or iron supplements, take them first as directed.

Afterward

- Drink 1 cup of warm lemon water to support hydration and digestion.

If You Experience Gas or Bloating

- Add 1/2 tablespoon fennel seed powder (saunf powder) to the water.



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Breakfast (~300-400 kcal)

Choose one of the following options:

Option 1

2 eggs, any style

1 slice whole-grain toast OR 1 small whole-wheat roti

1 cup tea or coffee

Option 2

Greek yogurt

Mixed berries or seasonal fruit

1 tablespoon nuts or seeds



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Breakfast (~300-400 kcal)

Option 3

Oatmeal prepared with milk

1 tablespoon nuts or seeds

Optional berries or seasonal fruit

Option 4

High-fiber, low-sugar cereal

Milk or Greek yogurt

Optional small serving of fruit

Optional

1 small serving of fruit may be added to any breakfast option.





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Convenient Protein Options

If you are short on time, one of the following may be used:

- Protein shake or protein smoothie
- Protein powder mixed with water or milk
- Protein bar, preferably high protein and low sugar
- Aim for approximately 20-30 g of protein at breakfast whenever possible.

Beverage Options

Tea or coffee may be consumed with or without milk.

If desired, use a calorie-free plant-based sweetener such as stevia.

Avoid sugar whenever possible.

DSM Multi-Collagen

DSM Multi-Collagen may be added to coffee, tea, water, smoothies, or warm milk.

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Mid-Morning Snack (~100-150 kcal)

Choose one of the following:

- 1 medium apple + 10-12 almonds
- Greek yogurt + 1 tablespoon mixed seeds
- Seasonal fruit
- Protein shake
- Protein bar, high protein and low sugar

Supplement

Creatine Monohydrate - 5 g daily

- May be mixed with water.
- May be added to a protein shake or smoothie.
- If exercising, it may be taken after your workout.



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Lunch (~350-400 kcal)

Choose one of the following options:

Option 1

120 g chicken, fish, or lean meat

1 small whole-wheat roti OR 1/2 cup cooked rice

Large salad: cucumber, tomato, lettuce, onion, lemon

Option 2

1 bowl daal or beans

1 small whole-wheat roti OR 1/2 cup cooked rice

Large salad or cooked vegetables



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Lunch (~350-400 kcal)

Option 3

Grilled chicken or fish salad

Mixed vegetables

Olive oil and lemon dressing

Option 4

Cottage cheese (paneer) or tofu

Mixed vegetables

1 small whole-wheat roti

Supplements

Omega-3: 1,000-2,000 mg daily

Vitamin D3 + K2 as recommended by your
healthcare provider

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Afternoon Snack (~100-150 kcal)

Choose one of the following:

- 1 fruit
- Greek yogurt
- 10-12 almonds or mixed nuts
- Protein shake
- Protein bar, high protein and low sugar
- Vegetable sticks with hummus

This snack helps maintain energy levels and reduce evening cravings.





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Dinner (~300-350 kcal)

Choose one of the following options:

Option 1

120 g chicken or fish

Cooked vegetables or salad

Option 2

1 bowl daal

1 small whole-wheat roti

Mixed vegetables



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Dinner (~300-350 kcal)

Option 3

Cottage cheese (paneer) or tofu

Cooked vegetables

Option 4

Chicken or vegetable soup

Side salad

Evening Supplement (Optional)

Magnesium Glycinate 200-400 mg before bedtime



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Golden Rules

Hydration

Drink 2-3 liters of water daily.

Protein Goal

Include protein with every meal and snack whenever possible.

Physical Activity

Aim for at least 30-45 minutes of walking or moderate physical activity most days of the week.

Strength Training

Resistance or strength training 2-3 times per week helps preserve muscle and support metabolism.



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Golden Rules

Healthy Cooking Methods

Prefer grilling, baking, steaming, air-frying, or sauteing.
Limit deep-fried foods.

Sleep

Aim for 7-9 hours of sleep per night.

What to Avoid

- Sugary drinks
- Excess sweets and desserts
- Fried foods
- Packaged snacks
- Late-night eating



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Golden Rules

Remember

Consistency is more important than perfection. Small healthy habits practiced daily can lead to meaningful long-term results.

Approximate Daily Energy Intake

1,250-1,350 kcal/day. This may vary depending on food choices and portion sizes.

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Purpose

"Designed to support gradual, sustainable weight loss while preserving muscle mass when combined with adequate protein and regular resistance exercise. This is not a maintenance diet. After reaching the target weight, calories should be gradually adjusted to an individualized maintenance intake."

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